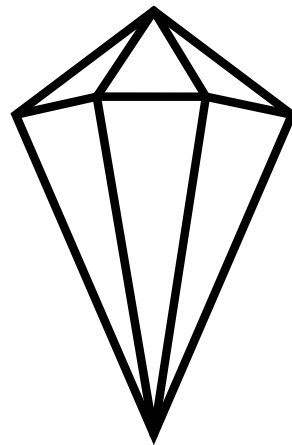


BOISE GEMS



**2025-2026
BG Color Guard
Video Audition Packet**

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I. INTRODUCTION

Congratulations on taking the first step towards becoming a member of the 2025 - 2026 Boise Gems Color Guard!

This packet includes information about the video audition process as well as the technique used in this program. Please read everything in this packet carefully and prepare the material to the best of your ability!

We have several goals that are a part of the audition process. We want to provide you an educational experience with lessons and skills that you will learn. We also want to create a positive and safe environment for everyone involved. Lastly, we want to promote innovation and creativity with what we do.



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Feedback will be provided on all auditions whether it be in person or through video.

We are very excited for this upcoming season! If you have any questions, don't hesitate to reach out to us via Slack or email.

**For in person audition information, please refer to the technique section of this document and the in-person rules/expectations document in the Google Drive.*

II. ABOUT THE BOISE GEMS

Gems History:

The Boise Gems is a recently established Drum and Bugle Corps in the Treasure Valley. Founded in 2022, Gems is the first drum corps to be created in Idaho and fielded our first show in 2023. We have had have had 3 successful seasons so far competing in the soundsport division.

The Goal of Gems:

The goal of the Boise Gems is to provide performers and musicians in the Treasure Valley with a strong program that will help them to become more well-rounded in both their life and their pursuits within the performing arts.

The Role of the Color Guard:

The color guard is responsible for providing the main visual aspect of our corpse. We bring life to the story and theme of each show and create a great visual effect for everyone to enjoy.

III. ATTIRE

Proper attire is **required** for both video auditions and all in-person auditions, camps and rehearsals. Reach out to any guard staff member for questions regarding attire.

Please ensure you have the following:

- Athletic clothing that is comfortable to spin and dance in.
 - Tank tops or t-shirts
 - Leggings, joggers, shorts, etc. Jeans are **not** considered proper attire.
- Either tennis shoes or jazz shoes.
- Longer hair should be pulled back and not in your face.
- **No** rings or large pieces of jewelry that will get in the way of spinning.
- Skin-colored Gloves are optional based on personal preference.

V. TECHNIQUE

This section will go over the technique and moves we use. Use it as a reference for your video audition. If there are questions or if you don't know something, please don't hesitate to reach out and we can help you the best we can.

Movement

- All movement technique should flow well and showcase confidence. It is ok if you are not very flexible, we would rather see technique compared to flexibility.
- **Foundations:** Pliés, tendus, dégagés, passés, battement, leaps, floor rolls, etc.
 - **Look up the names of these if you are unsure.*

Across the Floors

- **Foundations:** Jazz walks, jazz runs, sautés, chasses to the front and side, chasse sautés to the front and side, and chaine turns.

Flag

- Gems uses 6ft weighted flag poles.
- All flag technique should be strong, squeezing on each hit and catching tosses with both hands. Strong checkpoints and extension throughout each move is crucial.
- **Foundations:** Drop spins and double time on the right & left, flourishes on both sides, cones, single-double tosses, J (L) tosses, parallel tosses, and 45° tosses.

Rifle

- Gems uses 37" wooden rifles.
- All weapon technique should also be strong, squeezing on each hit and catching with both hands. Make sure hand technique is consistent, no thumb wrapping.
- **Foundations:** Consecutives (also referred to as drop spins), double time, flourishes, backhands (left & right hands), strap tosses, parallels, and single-quad tosses.

Sabre

- Gems uses 39" metal sabres.
- For consecutives, please practice the "pinching" technique. Do not fully wrap your hand around the sabre. Rely on your pointer finger and thumb to get it around.
- **Foundations:** Consecutives (drop spins), backhands (left hand), parallels, and single-quad tosses.

IV. AUDITION INFORMATION

There are **5 different sections** for the video audition process. For each section, there are requirements on what we want to see in the video auditions. Make sure that these requirements are incorporated into your combos, the rest will be left up to creative interpretation.

For each section (besides the intro), use either a song that's **100-130bpm** or a metronome **set to 100-130bpm**. You should be spinning/dancing **in time**.

1. Introduction

- Provide a brief introduction with information you feel comfortable sharing.
- Be sure to include your name, age, pronouns, where you are from, if you are a vet, and your past experience in color guard/marching band.

2. Movement

- Present a short movement/dance combo of your choosing. It can be an old dance routine from previous seasons, something you came up with, etc. This is an opportunity to showcase your style and movement technique.
- Include at least 2 things from the movement portion of the technique page above.

3. Across the Floors

- Jazz walks, jazz runs, sautés (any kind), and chasses to the front, all in time.

4. Flag

- Present a short combo on flag. This can be a warm up, previous show choreo, a combo you wrote, etc. Showcase what you are able to do on flag.
- **Please incorporate** drop spins, double time, single tosses, single ½ tosses, parallel tosses and 45 tosses from the hip.

5. Weapon

- If you are interested in rifle and/or sabre (not required), present a short combo showcasing what you can do on weapon. Please do separate routines for rifle and sabre if you are interested in both.
- **Please incorporate** consecutives (drop spins) on the right and left, tosses up as high as you can go, and double time (rifle only).

**If there are any questions or concerns about what is required, please reach out to a guard staff member. It is ok if you can't do something, we understand that the technique at different programs may vary. We will work with you the best we can based on the rest of your video audition.*